Powassan & District Union Public Library

Minutes for Monday, January 19, 2026 – 6:15 p.m.

Board Meeting @ Library

In-person: Debbie Piper, Steve Kirkey, Bernadette Kerr, Jennie Leblond, Pat Stephens, Larry Woodword, Marie Rosset

Via Zoom: Valerie Morgan, Randy Hall at 6:26pm

Recording of meeting

Item	Action	Responsibility
1. Call to order	6:16 pm	
2. Respect and Acknowledgement Declaration	Declaration read by CEO We respectfully acknowledge that we are on the traditional territory of the Anishinaabe Peoples, in the Robinson-Huron and Williams Treaties areas. We wish to acknowledge the long history of First Nations and Métis Peoples in Ontario and show respect to the neighbouring Indigenous communities. We offer our gratitude for their care for, and teachings about, our earth and our relations. May we continue to honour these teachings and recognize their value going forward.	
3. General Consent Motion: Presented the general Consent Motion for January 2026, which includes: a) Approval of the January 19, 2026 Agenda with amendment b) Approval of Minutes from the December 15, 2025 meeting c) Approval of the December 2025 Financial Statements d) Approval of the November and December 2025 Library Reports	**Motion: 2026-01** **That the General Consent Motion for January 2026 be adopted as amended.** **Moved by**: Jenny Leblond **Seconded by**: Bernadette Kerr Carried.	
4. Disclosure of pecuniary Interest	None	

5. Business a) Update on hiring of new CEO	Hiring Committee is having its first meeting tomorrow on January 20th at 4:45pm to start the process of hiring the new CEO. A consultant from OLS will be attending via Zoom to provide their expertise.	Hiring Committee
b) Recruitment of New Board members	- Sue Oshell sent her regrets and will not be joining the Board. - Municipality of Powassan will be contacted to advertise for 2 new board members until the end of this term - Staff and CEO will continue to gauge interest from qualified patrons	CEO, staff members
c) Operating Hours	- After a discussion on current operating hours, CEO recommended that **the hours be left as they are until the new CEO is hired and the fall municipal elections are over - the <u>Board agreed</u>.** - Board requested that a survey be completed with our newsletter recipients to determine which day they would choose to cut if we had to reduce the library hours.	CEO, Communication Coordinator
d) Security Contacts	- Pat Stephens agreed to be the replacement for Tina Martin as the third contact person for the security company.	Pat Stephens
e) Annual Report	Document is in progress and will be ready to send along with the approved 2026 Budget.	CEO
f) Grants update	- Applications for the Provincial 2026 Ontario Seniors Community grant and the Federal Canada Summer Job Program have been submitted. - CEO is looking into Capital Grants to subsidize the repairs to the elevator.	CEO

g) Library Agreement Renewal Update	- Meeting is still pending. Next meeting will potentially be scheduled for February 2026. - Powassan Councilor informed the Board that he is looking into the cost and possibility of Powassan leaving the Union and starting their own library at 250 Clark.	Randy Hall
h) Upcoming Activities	- January 28, 2026, representative from Service Canada will offer sessions on CPP - Author visit - John Lévesque - Music Meet Up – every third Wed. monthly - Fish Hatchery up and running - Free tech help every Wednesday with appt. - Members suggested that public presentations be scheduled on the following subjects: MAiD, local Hospice Care, Anti-fraud, Financial Planning.	
6. Correspondence	- Email from Sue Oshell sending her regrets.	
7. Committee Reports a) Property Committee	Two companies were contacted to get quotes to make the elevator well waterproof. - Greater City Concrete Works Limited was recommended by the Elevator Repair Fellow and quoted$6,080.40 +HST - Gateway Construction from North Bay quoted $4,285 +HST - Working with Underground Solutions to get a third quote.	CEO
b) Financial Committee	- The 2026 budget was presented and adopted with the addition of $4,000 in Maintenance for making the elevator well waterproof. **<u>Motion: 2026-02</u>** **That the 2026 Budget be adopted as amended with the addition of $4,000 to maintenance for elevator repairs.** **Moved by**: Steven Kirkey **Seconded by**: Larry Woodward Carried.	CEO

	- The Budget will be sent out to three Municipalities along with the 2025 Annual Report and the letter from the Chairperson. - Audit is scheduled for the week of March 9th to 13th, with final report presented at the April 20, meeting.	CEO, Breya
c) Policy Committee	- RES-04 Health and Safety Policy was reviewed by Board members and approved without recommending any changes. - Board members reviewed the new PDUPL Conduct Response Matrix and made several valid suggestions to improve it.	CEO
d) Friends of the Library	- The Friends did not meet in January, so nothing to report.	
8. Adjournment	**Motion: 2026-03** That the January 19, 2026, meeting be adjourned at 7:36 pm. **Moved by**: Pat Stephens	Next meeting: February 23, 2026, at 6:15 pm

Chair: _____ **Recorder:** _____

Debbie Piper **Marie Rosset, CEO**